

Experimental Analysis of Binary Search Models in Trees

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Outline

- 1 Problem Definition
- 2 Experimental Setup
- 3 Algorithms
- 4 Experimental Setup
- 5 Results: Uniform Costs
- 6 Results: Non-Uniform Costs
- 7 Key Contributions
- 8 Future Directions

The Tree Search Problem

Problem Statement

Given a tree $T = (V, E)$ with a hidden target vertex x :

- Query a vertex v with cost $c(v)$
- If $v = x$: target found
- Otherwise: receive the subtree containing x
- Goal: Minimize worst-case total query cost

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Problem Variants

- **Uniform costs:** $T || V || \text{COST}_{\max}$ – all queries have unit cost
- **Non-uniform costs:** $T || V, c || \text{COST}_{\max}$ – queries have arbitrary costs

Computing Environment

- **Processor:** Intel Core i7-8700K (6 cores, 12 threads, 3.7 GHz)
- **RAM:** 32 GB DDR4
- **OS:** Debian Linux
- **Language:** Python 3.8+

All experiments ran single-threaded to ensure reproducible runtime measurements.

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Bounded Diameter Trees (T_D):

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Instance Sizes:

- Uniform costs: $n \in \{10, 11, \dots, 1000\}$
- Non-uniform costs: $n \in \{10, 11, \dots, 100\}$
- 10 instances per size

Cost Distributions Tested

① **Uniform costs** ($c \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 1)$):

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3 Exponential costs ($c \sim \mathcal{E}(\lambda = 1)$):

- Continuous distribution with rate $\lambda = 1$
- Many small costs, few large costs

Measured Performance Metrics

For All Algorithms

- **Average Runtime:** Mean execution time over all instances of size n
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For Non-Uniform Cost Algorithms

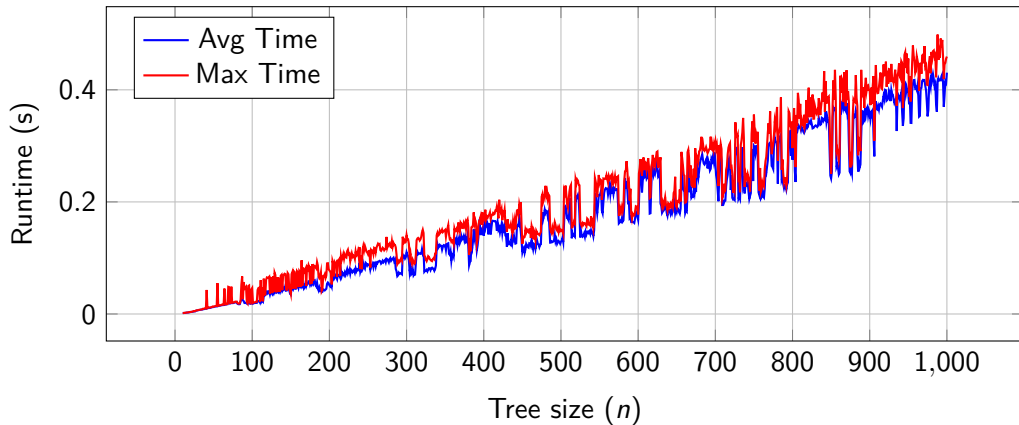
- **Average Approximation Ratio:** Mean of $\frac{\text{ALG}}{\text{OPT}}$
- **Maximum Approximation Ratio:** Worst ratio observed

$T||V||\text{COST}_{\max}$ – RankingBasedDT

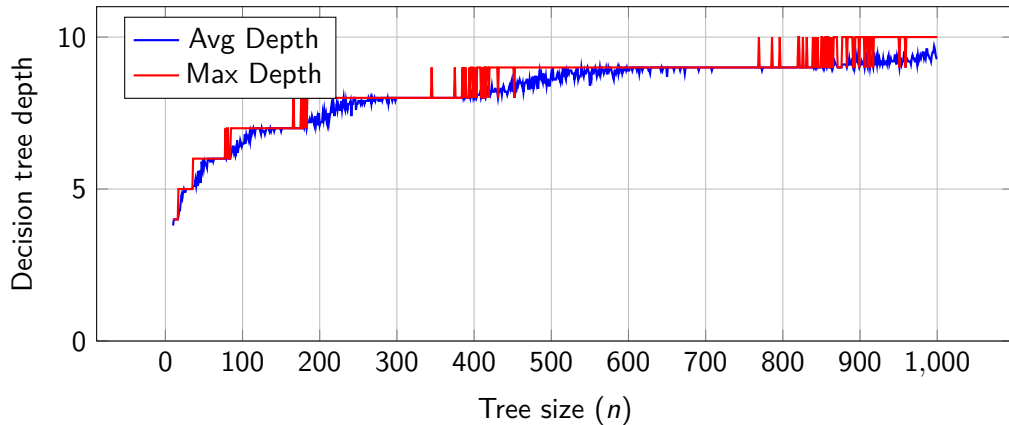
Optimal algorithm in $O(n \log n)$ time

- Based on vertex ranking coloring of trees
- Guarantees optimal decision tree depth

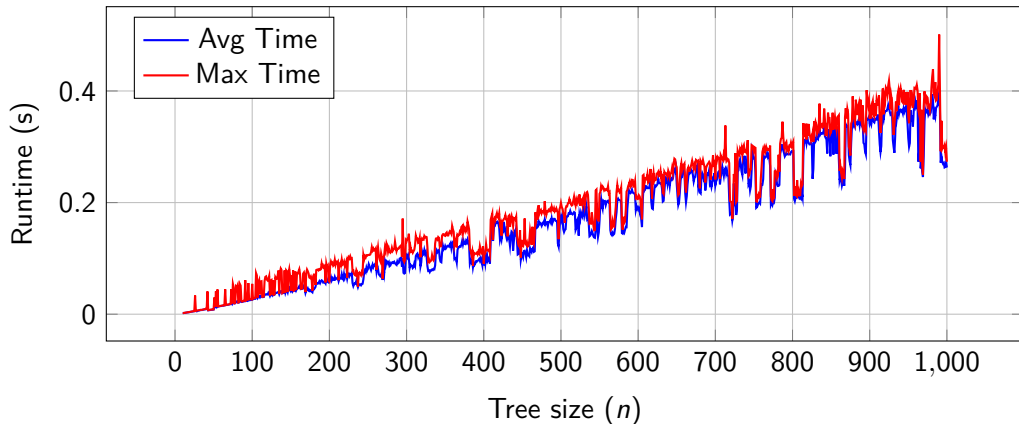
Random Trees: Runtime Performance



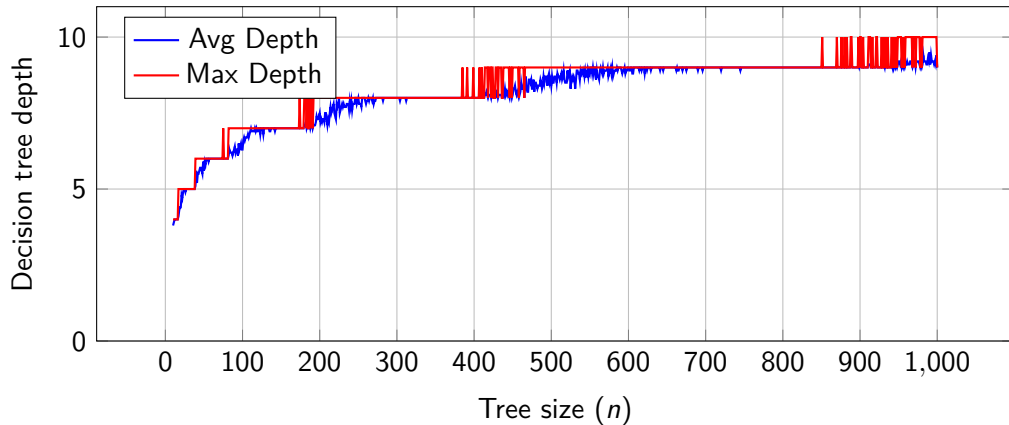
Random Trees: Decision Tree Depth



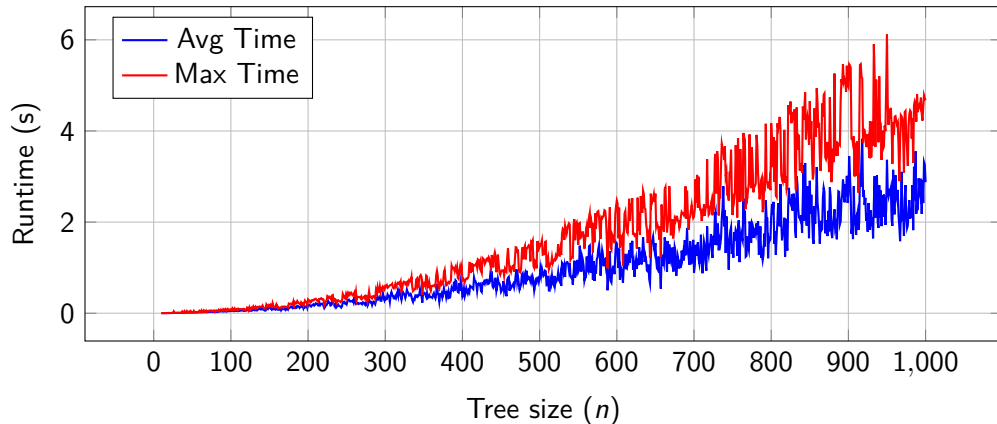
Bounded Degree Trees: Runtime Performance



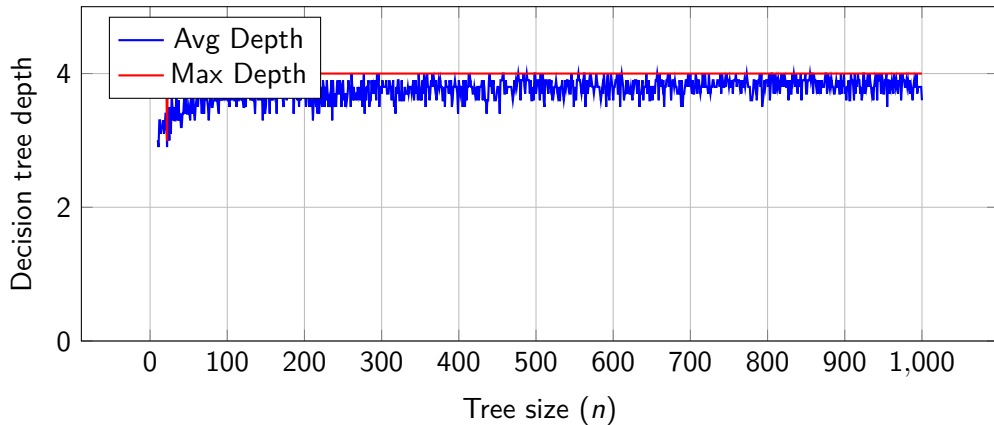
Bounded Degree Trees: Decision Tree Depth



Bounded Diameter Trees: Runtime Performance



Bounded Diameter Trees: Decision Tree Depth



Key Findings:

- Runtime: Near-linear for random and bounded degree trees
- Runtime: $O(n \log n)$ for bounded diameter
- Depth: Logarithmic for random/bounded degree
- Depth: Constant (4) for bounded diameter

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Observations:

- Bounded diameter: trivial upper bound $\lceil \frac{\text{diam}(T)+1}{2} \rceil$
- Bounded degree: trivial lower bound $\log_{\Delta} n$
- Conjecture: For random trees:
 $\mathbb{E}[\text{rank}(T)] = \Theta(\log n)$ or w.h.p.
 $\text{rank}(T) = \Theta(\log n)$

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Random Trees: Exact Algorithm Runtime

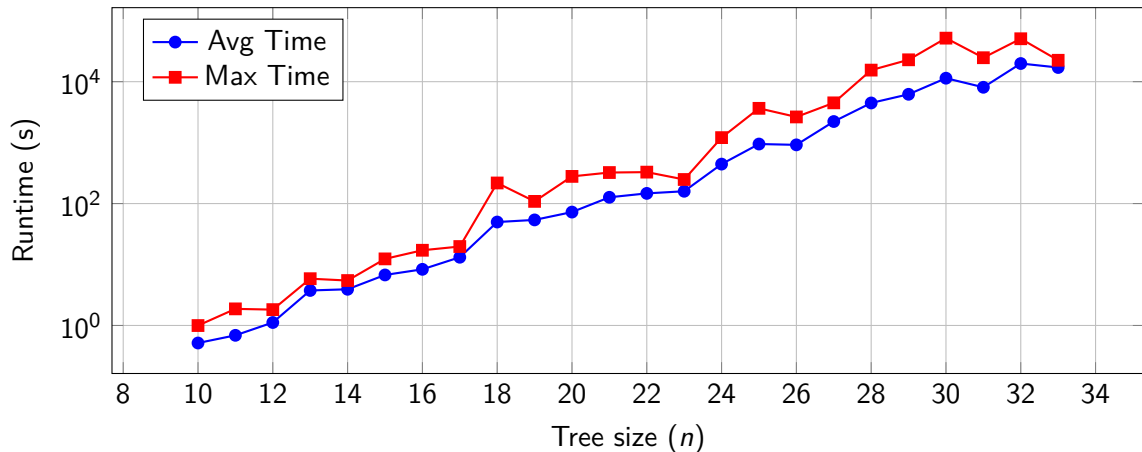


Figure: Random trees with uniform costs - exact algorithm: runtime

Random Trees: $O(\log n / \log \log n)$ -Approximation Quality

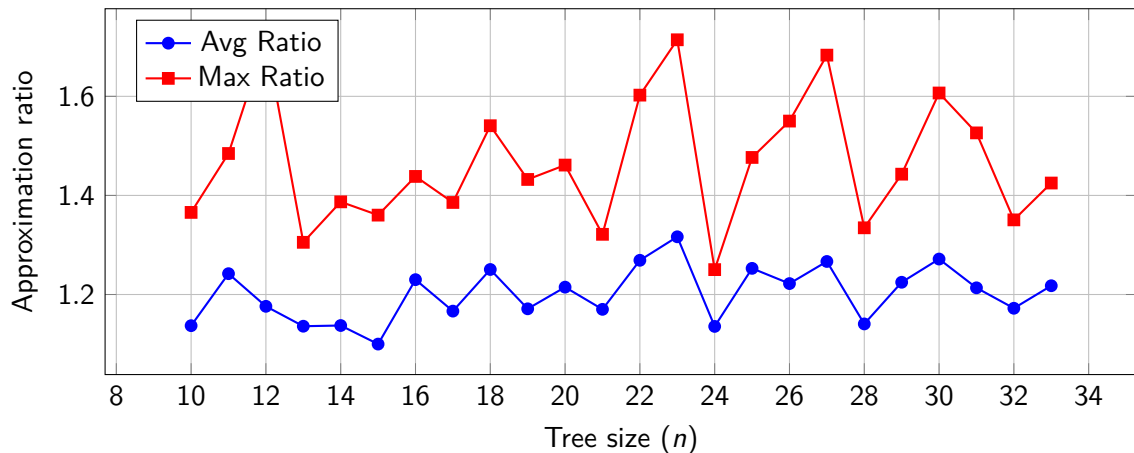


Figure: Random trees with uniform costs - $O(\log n / \log \log n)$ -approximation algorithm: approximation quality

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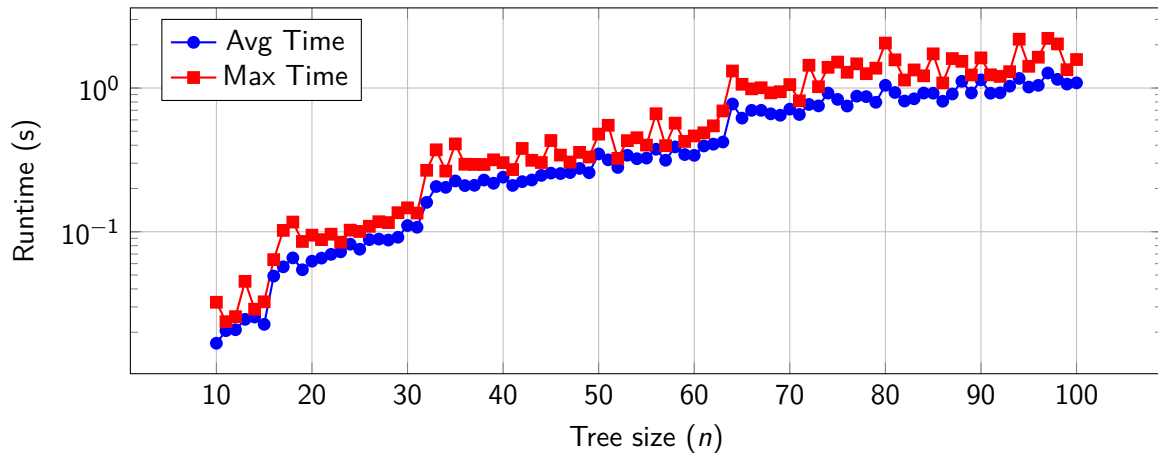


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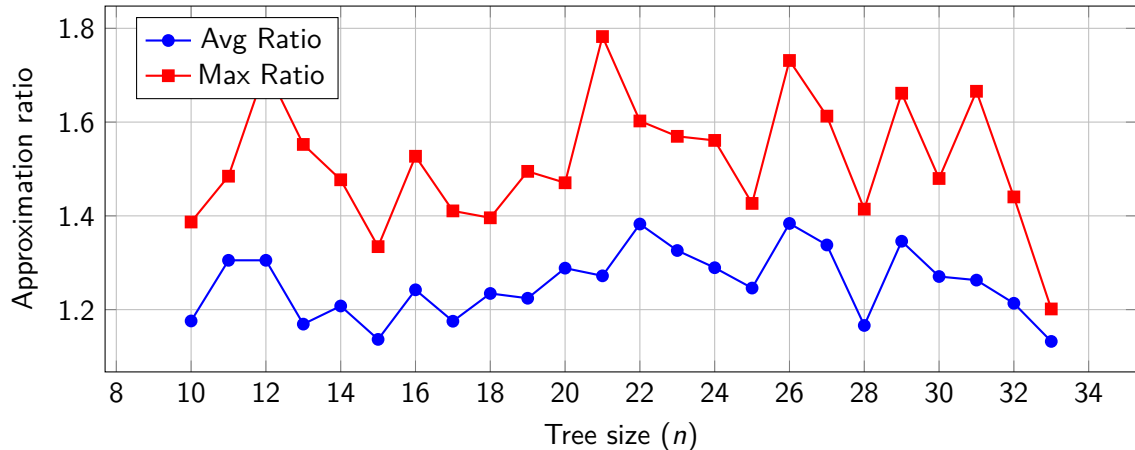


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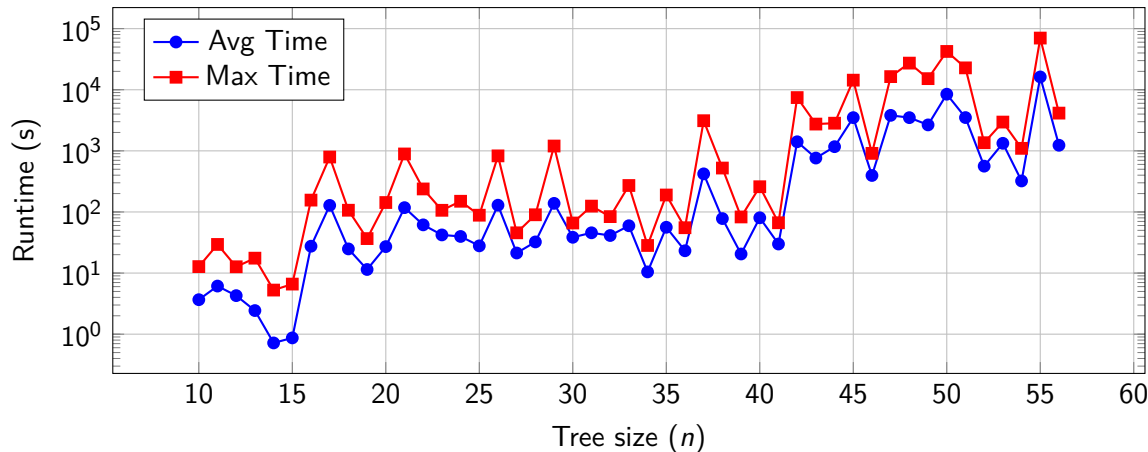


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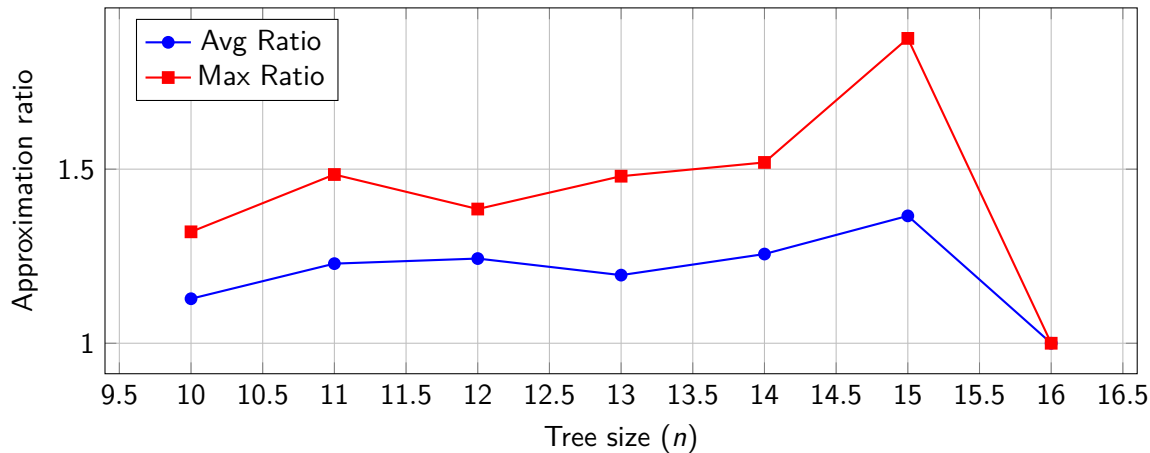


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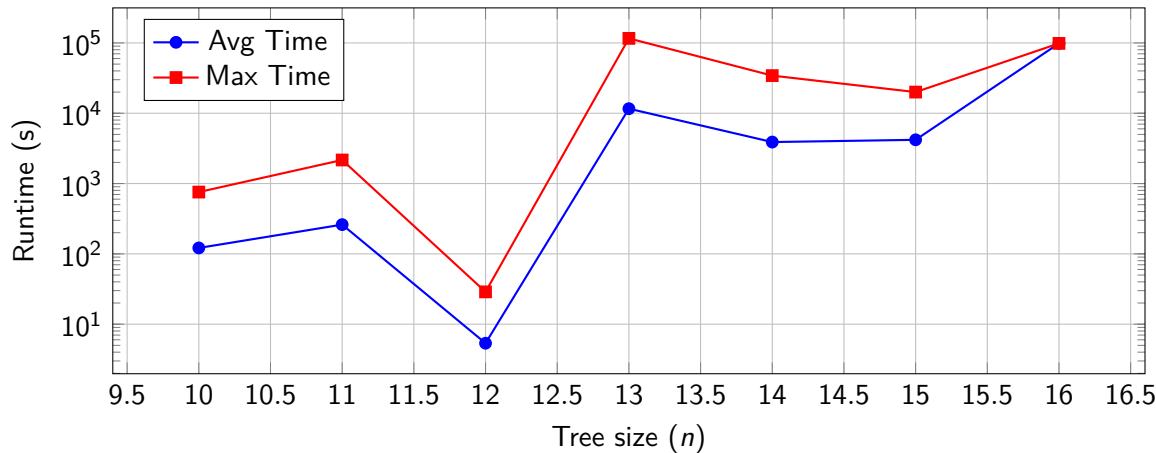


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Exponential function regression: $T(n) = b^n$

Fitted bases b for different tree types:

- Random trees: $b \approx 1.34 - 1.39$
- Bounded degree: $b \approx 1.35 - 1.38$
- Bounded diameter: $b \approx 1.51 - 1.61$

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Practical implications:

- Much better than worst-case $O(2^n)$
- Solved instances up to $n \approx 33$ vertices
- Matches theoretical bound $O(1.42^n)$ w.h.p. for random trees

Approximation Ratios

All algorithms achieved:

- Average ratios: < 2.0 across all configurations
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Surprising observation:

- $O(\log n / \log \log n)$ -approximation often performed *best*
- More greedy approach works better on random instances
- $O(\log \log n)$ -approximation slightly worse due to multiple cost levels

Practical Usability

- $O(\log n / \log \log n)$ -approximation: practical for $n \leq 100$
 - Stable runtime, no spikes
 - Recommended for practical use
- $O(\sqrt{\log n})$ and $O(\log \log n)$: limited to small instances ($n \leq 50$)
 - High variance in runtime
 - QPTAS bottleneck when $\text{rank}(T)$ is large

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QPTAS behavior:

- Runtime: $n^{O(\log \text{rank}(T)/\epsilon^2)}$
- Path-like auxiliary trees cause slowdowns
- For bounded diameter: becomes PTAS with $n^{O(D/\epsilon^2)}$ time

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- Simple greedy algorithms perform well on random instances
- Exact algorithm practical for $n \leq 33$
- $O(\log n / \log \log n)$ recommended for larger instances

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2 Practical Insights:

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3 Structural Observations:

- Random trees: $\text{rank}(T) = \Theta(\log n)$ (conjectured)
- Exact algorithm: base $b \approx 1.42$ for random trees
- QPTAS becomes PTAS for bounded diameter trees

Open Problems and Research Directions

Algorithmic Improvements

- Design simpler QPTAS with smaller constants
- Constant-factor approximation or PTAS?
- Improve exact algorithms (similar to other combinatorial problems)

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Theoretical Questions

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- Inapproximability results beyond trivial bounds
- Close gap between $O(\sqrt{\log n})$ and lower bounds

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Structural Properties

- PTAS for bounded degree trees?
- Better bounds on number of connected subtrees

Thank you for your attention!

Questions?